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SukiSukiCos Storefront Website Project Review

1. **Project Title and Overview:** Revisit your proposal and provide a final overview of your project, noting any changes from the original plan.

In my initial proposal I explained that I wanted to create a front-end page of a cosplay clothing store to sell Asian pop culture character cosplay. Key features that I wanted to include were pictures of items, main product pages, a search bar, reviews, navigation, scaling images, and a checkout page. The main changes is that there is no proper checkout page or function cart, the search bar is not present, and reviews were only displayed as a number next to the star ratings.

In place of the checkout page is a mock-up of a sidebar cart that can be opened by clicking on the cart icon. This sidebar visually displays the first item from the home page as if it was added. Unfortunately due to time constraints working alone I was unable to program the functionality of adding items to the cart and updating the total cost. The user can click a button that displays an alert from Javascript saying that their item has been purchased.

The rest of the project was built with working functionality. This includes a selection of products on the home page that scale once they are hovered over. A navigation header area at the top, additional links at the bottom, an example video on the home page, individual product pages, and working general navigation.

2. **Target Audience:** Reconfirm your audience and describe how your final product addresses their needs.

Once again, my target audience is young teens (13+) and young adults (up to early 30's) who have interests in Asian pop culture and the characters' costumes associated with it. My final product addresses their needs by clearly displaying cosplay items in a friendly manner that is easy for the eyes and easy to navigate. Each product page comes with additional photos, a simple description, materials, and a size chart that the audience can look at for more information. The video shows an example of what it looks like to wear and move in the cosplay. Cosplay is a way to express and explore yourself as well as a relaxation away from everyday work life and I believe my project has shown this.

3. **Core Features:** Highlight the key features of your website. Indicate which technologies (HTML, CSS, JavaScript) were used for each feature.

One key feature is the header area with the logo and navigation bar which use HTML and CSS to bring in the images and text elements. Javascript is used to provide the additional bar that opens navigation text when the screen gets smaller than 600px for mobile users. Below every page is also the footer which includes additional links that take the user to other pages or HTML by using HTML 'a' element and 'href'.

The products and their related features on the home page are created with HTML and CSS to create different columns holding a number of products with spacing between them. Below on the homepage is a video brought in with HTML and fit to the screen using CSS. For individual product pages, Javascript is used to change the main image with one of the sub-images through simple functions. CSS organizes two columns on the page where the images are on the left and the information is on the right. A size dropdown menu is available to select a size from small to XL and a number input box is displayed with customized increment buttons of '+' and '-' to adjust quantity. There is also a submit button with no functionality, but if it worked it would add the item to the sidebar cart according to item name, price, size, and quantity.

Though not the main focus and not remarkable, I have created a simple About and Contact page that can be clicked to navigate to. Every HTML is able to open the mock-up cart through Javascript that adds the class of 'active' to the cart page when the cart is clicked. When the cart page is open, users can click the 'X' button at the top right to close the cart with a function that removes the class of 'active' from the cart page.

4. **Design and UX Considerations:** Summarize the visual design choices and user experience optimizations made during development.

I designed the website following closely to the drawing of my mock-up aside from the checkout page. The home page includes large visuals of the products with their title, star ratings, number of reviews, and price. Images were rounded at the corner to bring more of a bubbly vibe to the site. Red, pink, and white were the primary colors with the star ratings being green and text being black. These colors are what I personally find to be playful as opposed to the site being mostly black and sharp; more fitting of a more mature and regular clothing store.

A large video is autoplaying while muted at the bottom of the home page to provide an example while not being intrusive to the user. At the very bottom are additional links that link to DokiDokiCos' socials, FAQ, and return policy since I do not

have my own references for this; except for the contact page. The text is spacious and contrasts the darker gray background to be easy on the eyes. To follow the color scheme, when hovering on the links they become a light red color and change the cursor to a pointer to show they can be clicked. Products and navigation text on the home page also change the cursor to a pointer to show they are clickable. Each product slightly scales when hovered to follow the bubbly vibe. It is like blowing a bubble and it gets larger with more air. That is the easygoing theme I wanted.

The logo for SukiSukiCos was admittedly generated because I am not a graphic designer by any means. With simple edits on my phone I made the logo's background transparent and easy to place in the HTML as an image. For the cart, stars, YouTube, X, Instagram, trash, and closing icons, I downloaded them from "fontawesome.com" which provides easy to use, customizable, and solid icons. Most titles are bold in black while more general descriptive text is gray or dark red to show different levels of text.

5. Challenges and Solutions: Reflect on the challenges you faced and how you overcame them.

The most difficult challenge was as I expected: working on the project solo meant that I could not share the burden with another team member to divide the task or share knowledge on how to create certain functionalities. As described in my proposal, if I ultimately could not figure out how to create a certain key feature then I would have to scrap the idea or attempt to replace it. Therefore the fully functional checkout page was replaced with a mock-up sidebar cart which just had the functionality of displaying an alert for the button, opening and closing, and changing quantity of the item.

An unexpected challenge was organizing the CSS styles. Using multiple elements in different areas and wanting each of them to be styled a certain way made me make the hard decision of having to write a lot of CSS for each element. Although not anywhere near desirable, it got the job done. Elements and their many, many assigned classes looked and behaved differently without causing effects to others.

6. Lessons Learned: Share what you learned during the project and how it has improved your understanding of front-end development.

The greatest lesson I learned is that proper organization is a must when it comes to creating a large project. While I have commented on certain areas in the HTML, CSS, and Javascript to note what belongs to what, eventually the code gets so massive that it becomes extremely difficult to understand even with comments. In a full-time job where you are working potentially thousands of lines of code, organization is essential. Therefore being able to consolidate is very important for anyone learning to code. When

creating a project, starting off with a mock-up, even if it is just a drawing like I did, is crucial to knowing what to code. I realized that the mock-up let me code towards a goal rather than mindlessly deciding how something should look on a whim. The result is a website that is much more organized and easy to use.

At the end of the day, coding in your own time towards something you are passionate about is the best way to improve your own understanding of front-end development. Doing assignments and watching videos will provide basic knowledge, but applying the elements in an HTML, writing the styles in CSS, and connecting them both with Javascript will help hardcode the knowledge.